

Happiness and Unhappiness

WORD LIST

anguish	blithe	congenial	defiant	desolate
despondent	disgruntled	disillusion	exuberant	gratification

There are lots of ways to describe how you feel. In this lesson, you will learn words that express happiness and unhappiness.

- anguish** (äng'gwish) from Latin *angustus*, "narrow"
 - noun** Great physical or mental pain; torment; torture
 - The thought of their missing child filled the parents with **anguish**.
 - verb** To suffer emotional pain
 - The patient **anguished** over which cancer treatment to choose.

"Filled with *anguish*" and "*anguish* over" are common expressions.

- blithe** (blith) *adjective*
Cheerful; carefree; lighthearted
 - Unconcerned about onlookers, the **blithe** teens gossiped and giggled as they walked down the street.

blithely *adverb* The dog played **blithely** with its new toy.

- congenial** (kən-jēn'yəl) *adjective*
Friendly; having a pleasant disposition
 - His boyish charm and **congenial** manner helped him win votes.

congeniality *noun* The restaurant hostess's **congeniality** made patrons feel at home.

Congenial can describe people with similar personalities or tastes.

- defiant** (dī-fī'ənt) *adjective* from Old French *desfier*, "to challenge"
Openly or boldly resisting authority
 - Defiant** workers gathered in the street to protest unfair treatment.

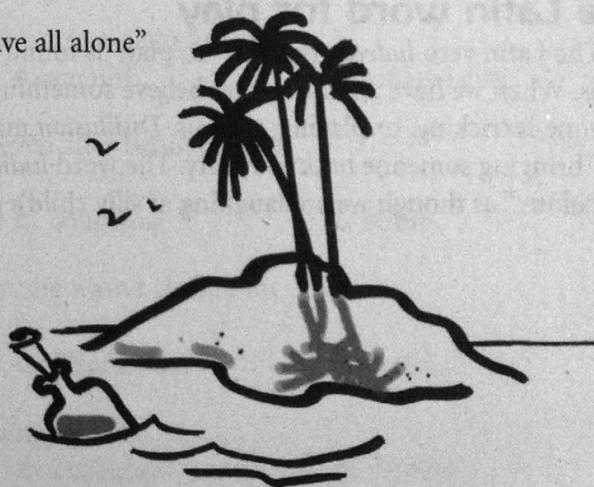
defy *verb* Alex **defied** his father by staying out past his curfew.

defiance *noun* In a show of **defiance**, the crowd refused to disperse.

- desolate** (dēs'ə-līt) *adjective* from Latin *desolare*, "to leave all alone"
 - Lonely and sad
 - When her three best friends moved away, the girl felt **desolate**.

- Having little or no life or vegetation; barren
 - The plane flew over a vast and **desolate** desert.

desolation *noun* Alone on the desert island, he was overcome with feelings of **desolation**.



desolate

6. **despondent** (dĭ-spŏn'dənt) *adjective* from Latin *despondere*, "to give up"
In low spirits; depressed; dejected
• The artist Vincent Van Gogh became **despondent** when people rejected his paintings.
7. **disgruntled** (dĭs-grŭn'tld) *adjective* from Middle English *grunten*, "to grunt"
Discontented; resentful
• The **disgruntled** employee complained to the personnel office when he failed to get promoted.
8. **disillusion** (dĭs'ĭ-lōō'zhən) *verb* from Latin *dis-*, "remove" + *ludere*, "to play"
To disappoint someone by breaking his or her belief in a false ideal
• If you expect the people you admire to be perfect, you may soon be **disillusioned**.
disillusionment *noun* Young Antonio's **disillusionment**, after meeting the obviously fake Santa Claus, kept him awake all night.
9. **exuberant** (ĭg-zōō'bər-ənt) *adjective* from Latin *exuberare*, "to be abundant"
Filled with enthusiasm and joy
• **Exuberant** after returning from a long tour of duty, the naval officer hugged her family members.
exuberance *noun* The crowd cheered in wild **exuberance** when their baseball team scored the winning run.
10. **gratification** (grăt'ə-fĭ-kā'shən) *noun* from Latin *gratus*, "pleasing"
Satisfaction; a feeling of being rewarded for one's efforts
• Their son's success brought **gratification** to the parents, who had struggled to put him through school.
gratify *verb* Dr. Bass was **gratified** that many former students remembered her.

WORD ENRICHMENT

The Latin word for play

The Latin verb *ludere*, meaning "to play," is found in a variety of English words. When we have an *illusion*, we believe something false, as though someone is tricking, or playing, with us. *Disillusion* means "to take away play," bringing someone back to reality. The word *ludicrous* means "ridiculous," as though we are laughing at silly child's play.

WRITE THE CORRECT WORD

Write the correct word in the space next to each definition.

- | | |
|--|------------------------------------|
| _____ 1. unhappy; resentful | _____ 6. to disappoint |
| _____ 2. friendly and sociable | _____ 7. depressed; in low spirits |
| _____ 3. openly resistant to authority | _____ 8. enthusiastic and joyful |
| _____ 4. great pain | _____ 9. having no vegetation |
| _____ 5. satisfaction | _____ 10. carefree and cheerful |

COMPLETE THE SENTENCE

Write the letter for the word that best completes each sentence.

- _____ 1. I always feel a sense of _____ when I get a thank you note for a gift I sent.
 a. congeniality b. desolation c. gratification d. disillusionment
- _____ 2. Children may become _____ when they discover that their parents aren't perfect.
 a. desolate b. disillusioned c. congenial d. blithe
- _____ 3. After winning the state spelling bee, the students were _____.
 a. desolate b. defiant c. despondent d. exuberant
- _____ 4. With exams over and spring underway, the campus center was filled with _____ students.
 a. anguished b. defiant c. disillusioned d. blithe
- _____ 5. When everything seems to go wrong, it's easy to become _____.
 a. despondent b. exuberant c. gratified d. congenial
- _____ 6. The student's _____ behavior was rewarded when he was voted "Most Friendly."
 a. congenial b. disillusioned c. despondent d. blithe
- _____ 7. The _____ on the faces of the injured crash survivors was plain to see.
 a. gratification b. exuberance c. anguish d. congeniality
- _____ 8. The _____ protestors continued to block traffic even after being ordered to leave.
 a. gratified b. defiant c. congenial d. blithe
- _____ 9. The _____ athlete complained to the coach when she wasn't chosen for the team.
 a. congenial b. exuberant c. disgruntled d. gratified
- _____ 10. After a day lost in the woods, the hiker was beginning to feel _____.
 a. gratified b. blithe c. exuberant d. desolate

Challenge: The injured runner's _____ showed on his twisted face, as he waited _____ for the ambulance.

- _____ a. anguish...despondently b. congeniality...exuberantly c. gratification...defiantly

READING COMPREHENSION

The Lost Love of Orpheus

According to Greek mythology, Orpheus was the greatest of all musicians. His beautiful songs brought happiness to the saddest hearts. Humans, animals, and even stones and trees gathered around to hear him sing and play the lyre.

When the adventurer Jason sailed in search of the Golden Fleece, Orpheus traveled on Jason's ship, helping the sailors through the long days and nights. (1) When tempers flared, Orpheus's singing restored *congeniality*. (2) Sailors, *disgruntled* with the length of the voyage, would feel their spirits lift when Orpheus touched his lyre. (3) Those *disillusioned* by the unexpectedly hard conditions at sea would feel contented, once again.

However, Orpheus's great charms could not prevent his own unhappiness. The story began when he fell in love with a beautiful maiden named Eurydice. (4) *Exuberant* with happiness, the young couple were married at a joyous ceremony. (5) But shortly afterward, as Eurydice was *blithely* walking through a field, a poisonous snake bit and killed her.

(6) Orpheus's *anguish* knew no bounds. He had lost his love on the very day of their wedding. (7) He sat by the rocks in *desolation*.

Finally, he decided that he would go to the Underworld and plead for his wife's return. His journey was long and dangerous, but his beautiful music helped convince the monsters who guarded the Underworld to let him pass. Finally, he came to the throne of Hades, the ruler of the Underworld. Charmed by Orpheus's music and his devotion to Eurydice, Hades decided to grant Orpheus's request. He agreed to let Eurydice return with Orpheus to the land of the living. Hades had only one

condition: Orpheus was not to look back at his bride until they had climbed to Earth's surface.

(8) The *gratified* couple began their long journey back to Earth, passing through the gates of the Underworld and traveling ever upward. Orpheus carefully kept his eyes on the path ahead of them. But just as they were about to pass into the sunlight, perhaps to reassure himself that she was really there, Orpheus suddenly looked back. Eurydice, calling out to him, vanished again into the Underworld.

Orpheus was heartbroken. His own carelessness had cost him his love. (9) *Defiantly*, he tried to descend into the Underworld again, but this time, even his music couldn't convince the guards to let him through.

From that day on, the joy went out of Orpheus. Abandoning the company of humans, he sat alone, playing his lyre for comfort. (10) The uplifting happiness of his music gave way to *despondent*, mournful tunes.



Each sentence below refers to a numbered sentence in the passage. Write the letter of the choice that gives the sentence a meaning that is closest to the original sentence.

- _____ 1. When tempers flared, Orpheus's singing restored _____.
a. hostility b. loneliness c. discontent d. friendliness
- _____ 2. Sailors, _____ with the length of the voyage, would feel their spirits lift when Orpheus touched his lyre.
a. tortured b. displeased c. happy d. lighthearted
- _____ 3. Those _____ the unexpectedly hard conditions at sea would feel contented, once again.
a. disappointed by b. enthusiastic about c. satisfied with d. tormented by
- _____ 4. _____ with happiness, the young couple were married at a joyous ceremony.
a. Resentful b. Satisfied c. Overjoyed d. Annoyed

NAME _____

DATE _____

- _____ 5. But shortly afterward, as Eurydice was _____ walking through a field, a poisonous snake bit and killed her.
a. pleasantly b. boldly c. lightheartedly d. sadly
- _____ 6. Orpheus's _____ knew no bounds.
a. pain b. cheerfulness c. happiness d. resistance
- _____ 7. He sat by the rocks in _____.
a. great anger b. sad loneliness c. a crowd d. silence
- _____ 8. The _____ couple began their long journey back to Earth, passing through the gates of the Underworld and traveling ever upward.
a. irritated b. enthusiastic c. despairing d. grateful
- _____ 9. _____, he tried to descend into the Underworld again.
a. Sadly b. Boldly c. Noisily d. Humbly
- _____ 10. The uplifting happiness of his music gave way to _____, mournful tunes.
a. sad b. quiet c. carefree d. satisfied

Indicate whether the statements below are TRUE or FALSE according to the passage.

- _____ 1. According to the myth, Orpheus's music had the power to bring happiness.
- _____ 2. Orpheus lost his love because he did not follow instructions.
- _____ 3. Orpheus recovered from his grief and was able to make joyful music, once again.

FINISH THE THOUGHT

Complete each sentence so that it shows the meaning of the italicized word.

1. A person might feel *disgruntled* if _____

2. A *congenial* person would _____

WRITE THE DERIVATIVE

Complete the sentence by writing the correct form of the word shown in parentheses. You may not need to change the form that is given.

- _____ 1. The _____ of the cheerleaders spread to the fans. (*exuberant*)
- _____ 2. The children _____ played on the rusty old swing set, unconcerned about getting hurt. (*blithe*)
- _____ 3. Though unhappy with their training, the _____ recruits refrained from complaining. (*disgruntled*)

- _____ 4. It will be difficult for voters to overcome their _____ after they were misled during the last election campaign. (*disillusion*)
- _____ 5. The friendliest contestant was voted Miss _____. (*congenial*)
- _____ 6. Refusing to speak to the police officer was an act of _____ by the suspect. (*defiant*)
- _____ 7. After losing the World Series, the team members were _____ as they answered the reporters' questions. (*despondent*)
- _____ 8. The mourners' _____ could only be appreciated by others who shared a similar loss. (*anguish*)
- _____ 9. Above the timberline, the terrain has a feeling of _____. (*desolate*)
- _____ 10. The film director seemed _____ by the lifetime achievement award presented by the academy. (*gratification*)

FIND THE EXAMPLE

Choose the answer that best describes the action or situation.

- _____ 1. A job that probably would NOT require *congeniality*
 a. restaurant host b. prison guard c. politician d. salesperson
- _____ 2. Something that might *disillusion* you
 a. a lion's roar b. homework c. a friend's lie d. an enemy's criticism
- _____ 3. Something most likely to be *desolate*
 a. Mars b. a town c. a huge skyscraper d. a busy highway
- _____ 4. A cause for *anguish*
 a. a sad movie b. a death in the family c. a cash award d. a torn shirt
- _____ 5. Something that would be *gratifying*
 a. a toothache b. a tax form c. a grocery bill d. a promotion
- _____ 6. Someone who is *defiant*
 a. a supporter b. a leader c. a follower d. a rebel
- _____ 7. A reason to be *despondent*
 a. a new job b. a winning team c. a lost pet d. a minor cut
- _____ 8. An example of *exuberant* behavior
 a. hoping, praying b. writing, reading c. sitting, standing d. jumping, shouting
- _____ 9. Someone who usually appears *blithe*
 a. an aid worker b. a cheerleader c. a firefighter d. a police officer
- _____ 10. Someone who might be *disgruntled*
 a. a popular leader b. a benched player c. a contest winner d. a promoted worker